

GEOGRAPHY

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY



INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

MODULE - 9

PHYSIOGRAPHIC DIVISIONS **COASTAL PLAINS AND ISLANDS**

1

THE WEST COASTAL PLAINS

E

THE KARNATAKA COASTAL PLAIN



1

The Karnataka Coastal Plain from Goa to Mangalore is about 225 km long.

2

It is a narrow plain with an average width of 30-50 km, the maximum being 70 km near Mangalore.

3

The central part of this plain is crossed by numerous spurs projecting from the Ghats.

4

These spurs approach so close to the coast that the breadth of the lowland is reduced to 5-7 km at 14° N latitude where the Ghat's crest is only 13 km away from the sea.

1

THE WEST COASTAL PLAINS

E

THE KARNATAKA COASTAL PLAIN

**5**

Running like ridges, the spurs attain heights of more than 600 m near the Ghats.

6

At some places the streams originating in the Western Ghats descend along steep slopes and make waterfalls.

7

The Sharavati while descending over such a steep slope makes an impressive waterfall known as Gersoppa (Jog) falls which is 271 m high.

8

Marine Topography is quite marked on the coast.



Jog Falls

Sharavati R.

Karnataka
Costal Plain

1

THE WEST COASTAL PLAINS

F

THE KERALA PLAIN

1 The Kerala Plain also known as **Malabar Plain**, between Mangalore and Kanyakumari is about 500 km long.

2 This is **much wider than the Karnataka Plain** and at places it is 96 km wide.



3 It is a low lying plain and at no place its height exceeds 30 m.

4 The **existence of lakes, lagoons, backwaters, spits etc** is the significant characteristic of the Kerala coast.



1

THE WEST COASTAL PLAINS

F

THE KERALA PLAIN



5

The backwaters, locally known as **Kayals** are the shallow lagoons or inlets of the sea, lying parallel to the coastline.

6

The largest among these is the Vembanad lake which is about 75 km long and 5-10 km wide and gives rise to a 55 km long spit.

7

Kochi is situated on its opening into the sea.

8

This and several other lagoons have been joined together by canals to provide excellent inland waterways from the mouth of the Ponnani to Thiruvananthapuram.

4

THE COASTAL PLAINS

2

THE EAST COASTAL PLAINS



1

Between the Eastern Ghats and the East Coast of India are located the East Coastal Plains extending from the Subarnarekha river along the West Bengal Orissa border to Kanniyakumari.

2

A major part of the plains is formed as a result of the alluvial fillings of the littoral zone by the rivers Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna and Cauvery comprising some of the largest deltas.



IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

CHINA

PAKISTAN

OMAN

Garo Khasi Jaintia

BANGLADESH

SUBARNAREKHA RIVER

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

GODAVARI RIVER

MAHANADI RIVER

KRISHNA RIVER

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

CAUVERY RIVER

Ghats
Eastern

4

THE COASTAL PLAINS

2

THE EAST COASTAL PLAINS

3

Its western boundary is a discontinuous line of the Eastern Ghats.

4

In contrast to the West Coastal plains, **these are extensive plains** with an average width of 120 km although it may be as wide as 200 km in the deltaic regions and as narrow as 35 km in between the deltas.

5

This plain is known as the **Northern Circars** between the Mahanadi and the Krishna rivers and **Carnatic** between the Krishna and the Cauvery rivers.

6

Depending upon physiographic variations, the entire plain is divided into three regions:

2

THE EAST COASTAL PLAINS

A

THE UTKAL PLAIN



1

The Utkal plain comprising coastal area of Orissa is about 400 km long.

2

It includes the Mahanadi delta with Cuttack at its head.

3

There is thick layer of alluvium covering this delta.

4

The most prominent physiographic feature of this plain is the Chilka Lake in the south of the Mahanadi delta.

2

THE EAST COASTAL PLAINS

A

THE UTKAL PLAIN

- 5 This lagoon on the Orissa coast is about 70 km long and its maximum width on the north-east is nearly 22 km narrowing to about 7 km on its south-western end.



Mahanadi River at Cuttack with one of its arm feeding the Chilika Lake

6

- It is one of the biggest lake in the country and its area varies between 780 sq km in winter to 1,144 sq km in the monsoon months.

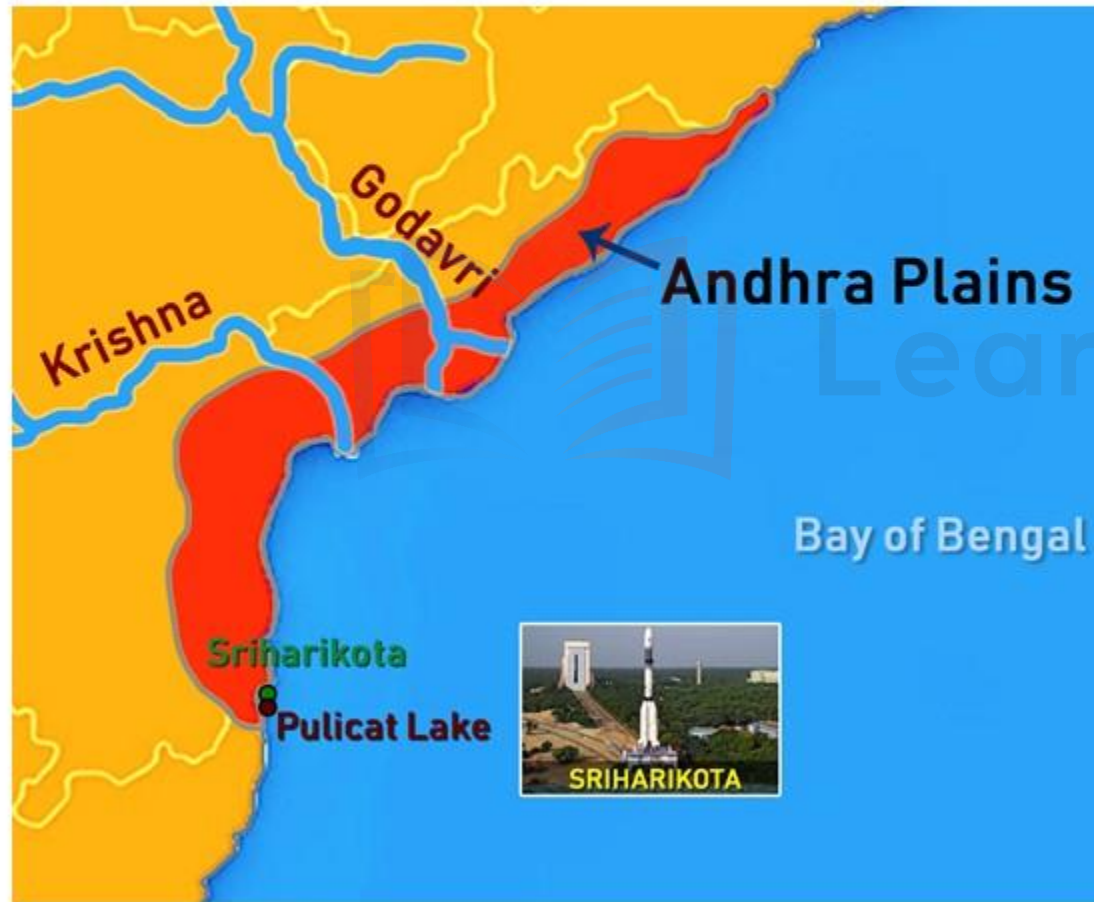


2

THE EAST COASTAL PLAINS

B

THE ANDHRA PLAIN

**1**

The Andhra Plain lies south of the Utkal Plain and extends up to Pulicat Lake, some 40 km north of Chennai,

2

This lake has been barred by a long sand spit known as “Sriharikota Island”, on which is located the satellite launching station of the Indian Space Research Organization.

3

The lagoon is about 60 km long and about 16 km wide in its widest part.

2

THE EAST COASTAL PLAINS

B

THE ANDHRA PLAIN

- 4 The most significant feature of this plain is the **delta formation** by the rivers Godavari and Krishna.



- 5 In fact, the two deltas have merged with each other and **formed a single physiographic unit**.

- 6 The combined delta has advanced by about 35 km towards the sea during the recent years.

- 7 This is clear from the present location of the Kolleru Lake, which was once a lagoon at the shore, but now lies far inland.

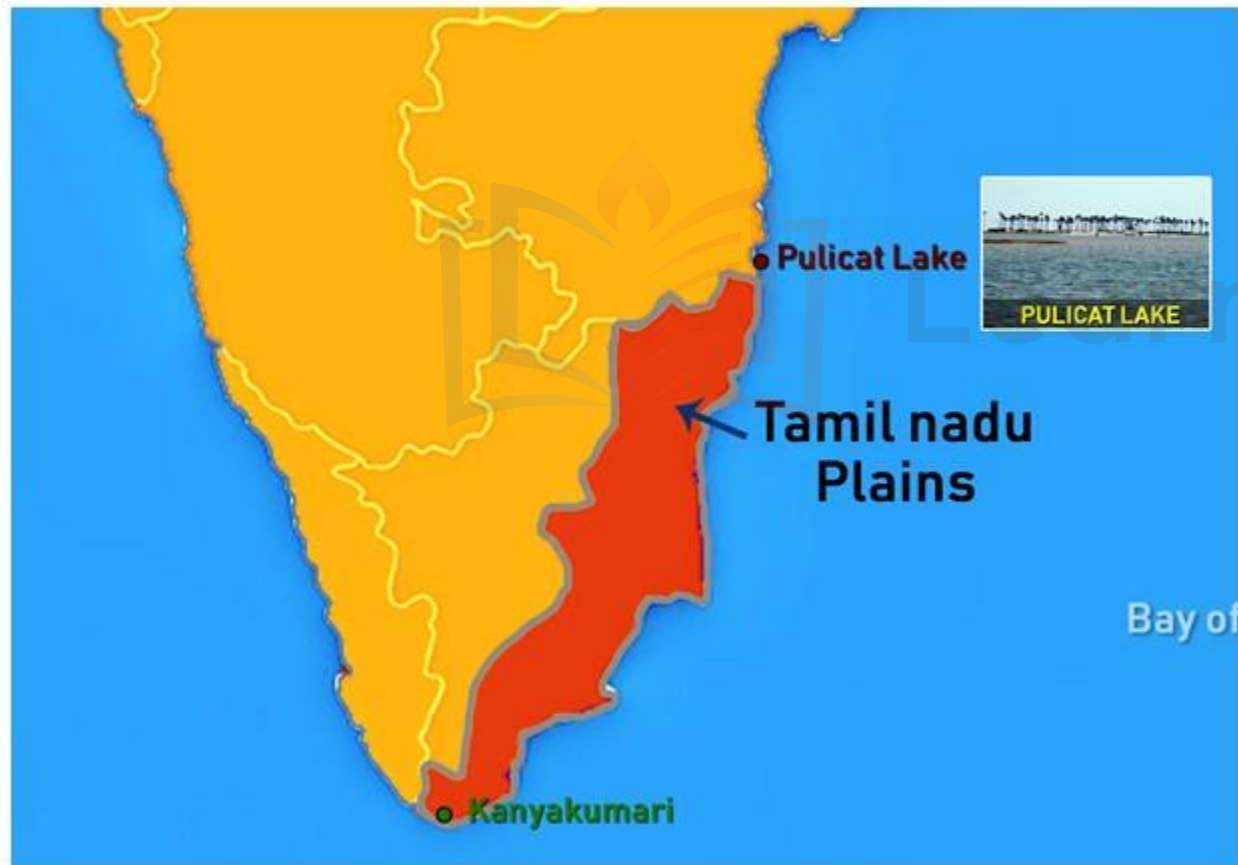
- 8 This part of the Andhra plain is quite wide, Andhra plain has straight coast and badly lacks good harbors with the **exception of Visakhapatnam and Machilipatnam**.

2

THE EAST COASTAL PLAINS

C

THE TAMIL NADU PLAIN



1

The Tamil Nadu plain stretches for 675 km from **Pulicat Lake** to **Kanyakumari** along the coast of Tamil Nadu.

2

Its average width is 100 km. The most important feature of this plain is the **Cauvery delta** where the plain is 130 km wide.

3

The fertile soil and large scale irrigation facilities have made the Cauvery delta the **granary of South India**.

SIGNIFICANCE OF COASTAL PLAINS



- 1 Large parts of the coastal plains of India are covered by fertile soils on which different crops are grown.
- 2 Rice is the main crop of these areas. Coconut trees grow all along the coast.
- 3 The entire length of the coast is dotted with big and small ports, which help in carrying out trade.

SIGNIFICANCE OF COASTAL PLAINS

4 The sedimentary rocks of these plains are said to contain large deposits of mineral oil.

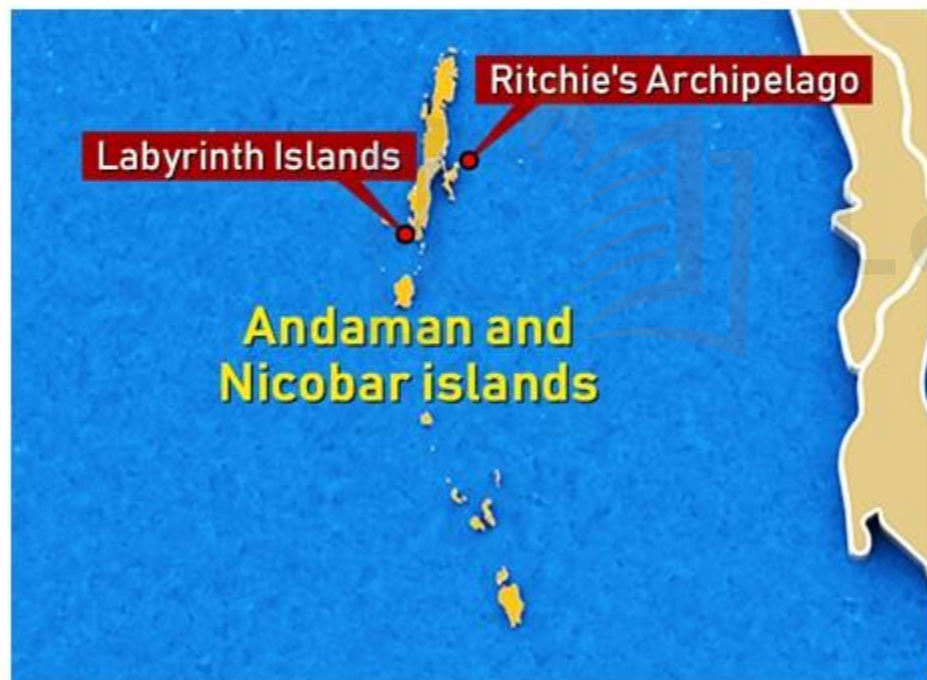
5 The sands of Kerala coast have large quantity of monazite which is used for nuclear power.



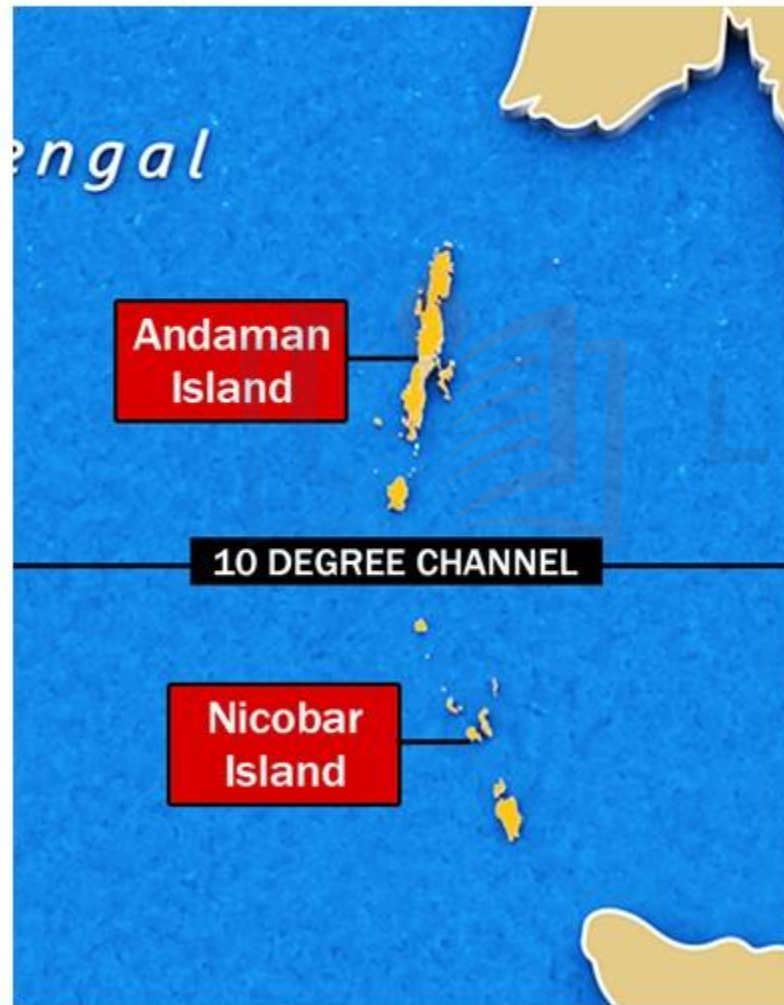
6 Fishing is an important occupation of the people living in the coastal areas.

7 Low Lying areas of Gujarat are famous for producing salt.





- 1 There are two major island groups in India; one in the Bay of Bengal and the other in the Arabian Sea.
- 2 The Bay of Bengal island groups consist of about 572 islands/islets.
- 3 These are situated roughly between 6°N - 14°N and 92°E - 94°E .
- 4 The two principal groups of islets include the **Ritchie's archipelago** and the **Labrynth island**.



5 The entire group of island is divided into two broad categories; the **Andaman** in the north and the **Nicobar** in the south.

6 They are separated by a water body which is called the **Ten** degree channel.

INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

THE ISLANDS



7 It is believed that these islands are an **elevated portion of submarine mountains**.

8 However, some smaller islands are **volcanic** in origin.

9 **Barren island**, the only active volcano in India is also situated in the Nicobar islands.

10 **Saddle peak** in North Andaman is the highest peak.

INDIAN PHYSIOGRAPHY

THE ISLANDS

11 The coastal line has some coral deposits, and beautiful beaches.

12 These islands receive convectional rainfall and have an equatorial type of vegetation.



13 The islands of the Arabian sea include Lakshadweep and Minicoy.

14 These are scattered between 8°N - 12°N and 71°E - 74°E longitude.





THE ISLANDS



15 These islands are located at a distance of 280 km-480 km off the Kerala coast.

16 The entire island group is built of coral deposits.

17 There are approximately 36 islands of which 11 are inhabited.

18 The entire group of islands is broadly divided by the Eleventh degree channel, north of which is the Amini Island and to the south of the Canannore Island.

19 The Islands of this archipelago have storm beaches consisting of unconsolidated pebbles, shingles, cobbles and boulders on the eastern seaboard.

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